SWINGING INTO ACTION

Not wanting to tread the same ground, ***Aditya Roy Kapur*** *is often picky about his projects. Releasing on July 1,* Rashtra Kavach Om *sees the actor reinvent himself as an action hero*

Q. You recently worked with Jackie Shroff in *Rashtra Kavach Om* and with Anil Kapoor in the *Night Manager* remake. Were there any big lessons you took from Ram-Lakhan?
It is an opportunity to imbibe as much as you can. It's always enriching to work with actors who have been there, done that and are still doing it. There's a hard-earned wisdom they have that just flows off the tongue.

Q. After your first action film, do you feel a new-found respect for Tiger Shroff, Ajay Devgn and Akshay Kumar, who have made their careers as action heroes?
Absolutely. When it is your eighth day without salt and you have to deliver a dialogue sounding coherent, you realise how tough it is. You don't have enough food and are supposed to do all this activity. But it became addictive. I was an action fiend by the end of it.

Q. You're one of the few actors who doesn't conform to the industry diktat that 'being seen is being relevant'....
The idea of being out there all the time isn't something that suits my personality. I can't do it. People have asked me to change, especially when things don't go well, but I find it's important to feel like I am living a normal life. I need to disappear and come back out for short doses.

Q. Having lost audiences to streaming, it was a tough two years for cinemas. Do you think the balance is being restored?
I think it's good that theatres are back and that the audiences are coming. It will, however, take longer for the water to find its level.

–with Suhani Singh



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